



HARVESTING

Beans for drying will be ready to harvest once the bean pods have withered and the plants are starting to shed their leaves. If the pods are completely dry, you can shell the beans as soon as you pick them. In a particularly wet season, leave the pods to dry in a well-aired, rodent-free place before removing the beans.

STORING

Place the shelled beans in an airtight container and use as required. If stored in a cool, dry place, they should keep for several months.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Slugs and snails are among the enemies of emerging bean seedlings because they eat the tender tips. To deter them, set up beer traps around your plot to attract them away from the developing plants, or use diatomaceous earth (DE), grit, or a line of copper tape as a barrier. Pick them off by hand as you spot them. Birds may target pods, so construct netting to deter them. In summer, bean beetles and black bean aphids may skeletonize or wither leaves; spray with an appropriate control or wash off and hand-pick the pests.